



THE TEAMWORK BETWEEN OBAMA AND HILLARY CLINTON WILL BE KEENLY WATCHED BY THE WORLD

THE KEY IS WHETHER HILLARY WILL BE SEEN AS OBAMA'S ALTER EGO IN FOREIGN AFFAIRS. IF SHE IS, YOU CAN BE CONFIDENT THAT HER WORD COUNTS.

have to watch what will be the price US will be willing to pay at our expense and their own."

However, the howl of protests emanating from India about America interfering in bilateral issues involving Pakistan had an impact. Krepon says that the new administration would do nothing to "override India's concerns". Amitabh Mattoo, professor of International Relations at JNU, says, "Obama is shrewd enough to realise that Kashmir more than Iran and Afghanistan will be a tar baby that could get very sticky and jeopardise Indo-US relations." Hillary made it clear to the Senate that on Kashmir, "The US role in this administration is the same as in previous ones: Facilitate settlement but do not mediate." For now India could rest easy—the Obama administration is not going to be as intrusive on Kashmir as initially feared.

WILL HILLARY BE PARTIAL TO INDIA?

When Obama announced that Hillary Clinton was to be his secretary of state, Washington DC's beltway looked on it as a masterly political move to unite a Democratic party badly divided during the campaign to decide its presidential nominee. Now how the two will work as a team is the most keenly watched interaction in the Obama administration. If as an expert says there is some daylight between the two, Hillary's position would become severely undermined. If she still harbours ambitions of becoming the president after Obama's term ends she needs to ensure that they work smoothly as a team. Krepon says, "Hillary is hugely capable, energetic and committed. The two will work as a team." Adds Schaffer: "The key is will she be seen as the president's alter ego in foreign affairs? If she is, you can be confident that the administration will back whatever she pushes."